

# Entity-Level Framing Annotation Guide

Reference Guide for Manual Annotation and Web-Based Entity-Level Framing Analysis

## 1. Task Overview

Assign ONE framing label to the target entity based on how it is portrayed within the sentence.

| Focus On                                                                                                                       | Do NOT Use                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Entity role</li><li>Actions &amp; relationships</li><li>Sentence-level context</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Sentiment polarity</li><li>Outside knowledge</li><li>Personal interpretation</li></ul> |

## 2. Framing Labels

| Label      | Definition                            | Example                                                                                                                                        |
|------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Legitimate | Acting lawfully or asserting rights   | "The Philippines stated that its actions comply with international law."<br>→ <b>Philippines = Legitimate</b>                                  |
| Aggressor  | Provoking conflict or violating rules | "China Coast Guard ships used water cannons against Philippine resupply vessels near Ayungin Shoal."<br>→ <b>China Coast Guard = Aggressor</b> |
| Defensive  | Responding to another actor           | "The Philippine Coast Guard deployed patrol ships in response to the incident."<br>→ <b>Philippine Coast Guard = Defensive</b>                 |
| Neutral    | Purely descriptive, no clear role     | "Officials from both countries attended the regional summit."<br>→ <b>Officials = Neutral</b>                                                  |

## 3. Decision Guide

| Step | Question                                | Label      |
|------|-----------------------------------------|------------|
| 1    | Violating norms or escalating conflict? | Aggressor  |
| 2    | Acting lawfully or asserting rights?    | Legitimate |
| 3    | Responding to another action?           | Defensive  |
| 4    | None or unclear?                        | Neutral    |

## 4. Rules

• Use only the sentence • One label per entity • Choose dominant role • If unclear → Neutral

## 5. Additional Examples

| Sentence                                                                                           | Entity            | Label      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------|
| China Coast Guard ships used water cannons against Philippine resupply vessels near Ayungin Shoal. | China Coast Guard | Aggressor  |
| The Philippines filed a diplomatic protest after the incident.                                     | Philippines       | Defensive  |
| Officials from ASEAN member states met to discuss maritime security.                               | Officials         | Neutral    |
| The government stated that the patrol operation followed international law.                        | Government        | Legitimate |

**Key Reminder:** Framing may be implied through wording, attribution, and narrative structure—not emotional sentiment.